

submission instructions on the form

Secure your data during travels

During your working travel your restricted data could be exposed. If you feel that your travel frequency may expose your data please keep in mind the following points to ensure that sensitive data contained in your devices will not be compromised:

- VPN - If you are connecting from an untrusted network you should use a VPN connection to avoid MITM Attack or similar.
- Devices in public places - If you are using your device in a public place someone could read restricted data from your screen, you should protect your screen with a special film that ensure your privacy, here you can find some samples.
- Speaking in crowded places - Ensure that when you are talking about restricted data you are in a secure place and no-one can hear you.
- 1Password travel mode - If you are approaching travel in a risky country or you have to leave your devices in an insecure place, please use Travel Mode in 1Password to ensure that your vaults will be safe if your device is compromised.

When traveling, there is the possibility that customs, border control, or other law enforcement agents demand that you provide the password to your laptop or mobile device. If this happens to you in regards to a company-owned account or device, GitLab recommends that you comply with any such requests without protesting. If you do end up providing a password to any device or account that has access to GitLab resources (including your personal devices), you should follow the process to engage Security on-call as soon as you can safely do so. Even if you do not provide a password, if any of your devices are permanently seized or even temporarily removed from sight, you should also engage the Security on-call.

For additional security specifically when traveling through an airport, the following advice is provided:

- Completely power-off laptops and mobile devices before any security checkpoints. This reduces the risk of attacks that may be conducted against machines in a sleep mode, where the disk encryption is not being actively enforced.
- Prior to the trip, remove any sensitive data from your local machine that is not absolutely required. Refer to the Data Classification Standards for more information.
- If you are aware of any circumstances with your travel that may present a unique security risk (such as traveling to speciality conferences like Defcon), you may request advice in the security-division Slack channel.

Expenses While Traveling

Understand the guidelines of our Global Travel and Expense Policy before you travel.

SECTION: finance/travel/sponsored.md

Related Travel

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Sponsored travel is travel usually to a customer site that is sponsored by the customer or entity usually through contractual services such as statements of work. Sponsored travel is billable to the customer or entity for paid services.

Booking Sponsored Travel

Lodging

Travelers are expected to choose lodging that meets the traveler's schedule and business needs. Receipts are required for all lodging.

Domestic or International Lodging

Departments will reimburse travelers for actual expenses up to 100% of the lodging rate for the destination city, as referenced on the US Government General Services Administration (GSA) website for domestic lodging and the U.S. Department of State website for international lodging.

GitLab recognizes there could be some situations where a lodging rate falls outside of GitLab's guidelines. The traveler must obtain pre-approval from the appropriate authorized approver through a NexTravel account. Out of policy lodging must be booked and approved through NexTravel. If the traveler does not obtain prior approval, the department may limit the reimbursement to the GSA per diem rate.

Meals and Incidental Expenses (M&IE)

Unless specifically requested by the customer in the SoW, travelers on billable travel are reimbursed the per diem rate for travel-related meal expenses for their travel destination. Receipts are not required (under any circumstances) for reimbursement of travel meals using per diem rates.

The M&IE rates include:

- Meals, drinks, tax & tip
- Incidentals · e.g., baggage carriers, bellhops and hotel staff

Travelers may put in a separate expense request for meals that are not billable such as a GitLab-sponsored customer lunch or dinner.

First & Last Day of Travel

First and last day of travel will be reimbursed.

Departure day · the day you leave your home or office.

Return day · the day you return to your home or office.

Incidentals

Travelers may include the daily incidental amount when determining the maximum M&IE rates. Gratuities for baggage carriers, porters, hotel staff (bellhops and house cleaners), and staff on ships, as well as ATM fees, bank fees, and check cashing fees are included in the daily incidental amount. Laundry expenses are included in the daily incidental amount for

international travelers. Travelers should not request reimbursement for any of these items.

Travelers may request reimbursement for laundry for domestic travel lasting seven (7) or more consecutive days.

Meal breakdown for International M&IE rates

Rates can be found on the U.S. Department of State M&IE Rates web page.

Flights and Transportation (Uber or Car Rental)

Planning flights far in advance can help you get cheaper fares when booking. For example, you can set alerts when there is a significant drop in price for your travel destination.

- Google Flights - Great for comparing flights
- Kayak - Great for comparing car rentals

Other Travel Recommendations and Policies

1. The company can accommodate custom requests. It is OK to stay longer on your trip. However, the extra days will not be covered by the company or customer.
1. Understand that the guidelines of Spending Company Money, especially the part about spending it like it is your own money, still applies for all expenses.
1. Always bring a credit card with you when traveling for company business if you have one.
1. Hotels will generally expect you to have a physical credit card to present upon check-in. This credit card will be kept on file for the duration of your stay. Even if your lodging was pre-paid by the company, the hotel may still require a card to be on file for "incidentals".
1. If you incur any work-travel related expenses (on your personal card or a GitLab company card), please make sure to save the original receipt.
1. When your trip is complete, please file an expense report via Navan Expense or include the receipts on your next monthly invoice.

Pricing Sponsored Travel

This is the policy for estimating pricing on sponsored travel for contracts.

Lodging and M&IE Per Diem Rates

Use the per diem rates multiplied by the days on site, as well as your two travel days.

Airfare and Transportation

Estimate the airfare and car rental prices by using the search sites and choosing a mid cost flight/rental. Consider the starting location of the employee projected to go.

Other Billable Expenses

If it is required to have a fixed contract price for sponsored travel, estimate the cost of other billable expenses such as parking, tolls, transportation to and from airport, internet services in hotel or flights, and other expenses that might be necessary to complete the

contract successfully.

For any policy not covered in this policy please refer to Travel
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SECTION: hiring/_index.md

At the core of our team's vision, mission, and strategy is our ability to impact GitLab's overarching mission: to make it so that everyone can contribute to and co-create the software that powers our world. When everyone can contribute, users become contributors and we greatly increase the rate of innovation.

As a Talent Acquisition team, we have an outsized impact on GitLab's ability to make this mission a reality, by connecting top talent to profound careers from wherever they are in a truly distributed, remote workforce.

Talent Acquisition Vision Statement

To create globally inclusive access to opportunities so that everyone can contribute to and co-create the software that powers our world.

Talent Acquisition Mission Statement

It is the Talent Acquisition Team's mission to predictably build distributed, representative teams that enable team members to co-create the future of software.

Our Guiding Principles

As we set out to achieve this vision, we will continue to rely on core guiding principles to define how we build toward the future.

1. Experience: Stakeholder experience is central to our craft. We are a partner, an advisor, and an essential component to building high performing teams and culture at GitLab.
1. Inclusivity: We design fair and equitable processes into the fabric of what we do. We believe Talent Acquisition has an outsized impact on the make-up of our teams, and we strive to continue to build them with inclusivity as a integral piece of our craft.
1. Predictability: Our ability to have the right team members, in the right roles, at the right time is imperative to execute on our commitments and plans as an organization. We strive for predictability: to build accuracy in our forecasts and enable the business to look around corners through strong relationships and data driven decision making.

Our Objectives and Roadmap

We strive to be as transparent as possible, but these sections are only available for our GitLab team members.

Talent Acquisition Strategy

Talent Acquisition Pages and Processes

Team Process Pages

- Talent Acquisition Productivity
- Talent Acquisition Alignment
- Triad Process
- Quarterly Updates Note: Internal only

{{% details summary="Shared Definitions" %}}

- Job: A job refers to the job title (ex: Customer Support Specialist). This will also be what appears on external job boards. In the case there are multiple positions open that are the same, and we only want to list once, we can have multiple 'openings' (see next section) opened within one 'Job'. Each job will have a unique identifier called a Requisition ID (example- 1001).
- Opening: A job can have multiple openings attached to it (ex: you are hiring 3 Customer Support Specialists. You would then have 1 'Job' and 3 'openings' against that job). A job can have multiple openings against it, but an opening can not be associated with multiple jobs. Each opening will have a unique identifier called an Opening ID (example- 1001-1, 1001-2, 1001-3).
- GHPiD: GHP ID is the link between Adaptive (what we use to track our operating plan) and Greenhouse (our ATS). A GHP ID has a one to one relationship with an Opening ID. It is the key interlock between our hiring plans and our Talent Acquisition activity. This is a custom field in Greenhouse.

{{% /details %}}

Team Playbooks

- Recruiter Playbook
- Hiring Manager Playbook (coming soon)
- Interviewer Playbook (coming soon)

Candidate Handbook Pages

Please find pages for potential and active applicants below.

- Candidate Handbook Page
- Talent Acquisition Privacy Policy

Interviewer Processes

- Interviewer Prep Requirements
- Conducting a GitLab Interview
- Greenhouse for Interviewers

Hiring Manager Processes

- Hiring Manager Processes
- Conducting a GitLab Interview

- Greenhouse for Hiring Managers

Candidate Experience Specialist Processes

- Candidate Experience Specialist Responsibilities
- ModernLoop
- How to Complete a Contract - CES Process

Recruiters and Sourcers

Opening a job

{{% details summary="Get your headcount assignments" %}}

- How to open headcount on R&D
 - How to open headcount on Sales and G&A
- {{% /details %}}

{{% details summary="Open a req in Greenhouse" %}}

- Instructions here
 - Open a kickoff session
- {{% /details %}}

{{% details summary="Evergreen requisitions" %}}

- Creating an evergreen req
 - Evergreen req guide
 - An Evergreen Job is a requisition that is 'always open'. More specifically, it is used when we have at least 3 openings for a particular job repeated each quarter. There is then one Evergreen job posted for internal, external and passive candidates. It is important that no candidate is hired to an Evergreen job, and instead is moved to an approved opening (aka an opening with a single corresponding GHPiD). TA Leadership will open EVG roles at the start of a fiscal year, with a quarterly review cadence, by leveraging the hiring plan and attrition assumptions. See the pages above for more information.
 - {{% details summary="Tips and Tricks" %}}
 - Know your department before you open your req. If you need to change the department name later, the approval chain will not automatically update. If this happens to you, please contact Enablement.
 - We do not re-open jobs after they have been closed. This is because permissions and approvers may have changed in the time since the job was first closed.
- {{% /details %}}
- {{% /details %}}

{{% details summary="Post a job in Greenhouse" %}}

- Post an internal job
- Post an external job
- Using Rules
- Auto-tags

- {{% details summary="Tips and Tricks" %}}
- Salary transparency: In select US states, GitLab discloses salaries in job descriptions in accordance with local laws. Total Rewards will add this information to the job's approvals page. When you create your external job post, utilize Pay Transparency Rules and select Hiring in the USA. If the job will not be posted in the US, select N/A.
- EEOC questions should be checked off in the US only
- Click here for more information on selecting the correct location for your job. This will help ensure that your LinkedIn listings are posted in the correct countries.
- Our jobs are now set up to automatically go to Indeed and Glassdoor and be posted as remote roles on both sites. Recruiters should unselect or leave unselected the option in Greenhouse to "publish to free job boards" as this requires us to input city, state, and country data that overrides the remote job listing. There is an automation in place to automatically send jobs to Indeed and Glassdoor.

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{{% details summary="Req access and permissions" %}}

- As a member of the Talent Acquisition team, you have the ability to add team members to view your job with differing layers of access. By default, all team members can access the interview kit & scorecard of someone they're interviewing and this access does not need to be granted. For team members who require additional access, such as a Hiring Manager or their EBA, you will need to grant that access where appropriate. You can use this guide to help determine the appropriate access.
- As you are deciding what access level someone should have, default to the setting that allows the most confidentiality for a candidate. If a team member does not need access to scorecards, for example, we should be choosing an access level that does not allow them to see them. A job admin (someone with higher level permissions) typically should not be at the same level or a direct report of a job they have access to. Recruiters typically grant only Hiring Manager access - interviewers do not need special access and cannot access scorecards or candidate profiles through Greenhouse.
- To add or remove access in a job, go to 'job setup' and click 'hiring team'. Add or remove access under "Who can see this job?". Unfortunately, there is no way to bulk add or remove access. You can also add and remove access when creating your job from a template. If you are searching for a team member and cannot find their name, ensure that you do not have filters activated. Do not grant admin access through templates, because this could create problems in the future.

{{% /details %}}

{{% details summary="Set up scorecards and interview plans" %}}

- There are two elements of a scorecard: the Scorecard section and the Interview Plan section. Both are accessible through Job Setup.
- Scorecard Depending on your department, you may have a lot of your scorecard options pre-filled. R&D scorecards are always set up for you, and may only require small tweaks depending on technical language or job grade.
- Interview Plan
- {{% details summary="Tips and Tricks" %}}
- Name your interviews in a way that will help your Candidate Experience Specialist partner schedule your interview. We recommend 'Topic - Interviewer - Time' i.e. 'Values Interview -

Beyonce Knowles - 45 min'. If you are pulling from a large interviewer pool, you can discuss with your Candidate Experience Specialist partner if it makes sense to create a Prelude interviewer pool that will help with scheduling.

- Once you have set up the stages and interview names, add the specific interview questions asked into the "Interview Questions" section of the Interview Plan.

- If you need to make bulk changes to a large number of jobs' scorecards at once, Enablement has the ability to make bulk changes. Please contact them for assistance.

- Recruiters don't need to be the only ones adding interview questions to the interview plan.

Invite your Hiring Manager to complete this task alongside you.

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{{% /details %}}

Interview Stages

{{% details summary="Stages Overview" %}}

Please note that the names of stages is important, and we should only have stages with the names listed below. Anything outside of these stages will not appear on reporting.

Scorecards are required in all stages that require interviews. Confidential, personal information and disclosures about being part of a protected class are never to be written in scorecards. Recruiters can add salary information into Private Notes outside of the scorecard to maintain confidentiality.

- Get to Know Us: This is an application review stage.

- Qualified: This is the stage where positive applications will be triaged. Candidates can wait here to be scheduled for interviews, to ensure the right mix of well-qualified candidates are screened at the right times.

- Screening: Phone or video interview with a recruiter, scheduled through Calendly.

- Assessment: This is an optional stage where written assignments can be submitted. [Learn more here.](#)

- Initial Interview: This is the first video interview with a member of the team, which helps determine if they will move forward to additional interviews. This stage ensures we are utilizing the interviewers' and candidates' time thoughtfully, and is typically either a Hiring Manager or Technical interview.

- Team Interview: All other team interviews live here.

- Debrief: This will come after the reference check stage for Engineering requisitions, because the reference checks will be initiated as the Justification (R&D's process for the Debrief stage) is initiated. For non-Engineering departments, this will be a holding stage where candidates wait until a decision is made, to track the time it takes for us to reach a decision on a candidate who has completed their interviews. See the Engineering's Justification process.

- Reference Check: The reference check stage can sometimes be done in tandem with the Debrief and Background Check and Offer stages. They can be completed by the Hiring Manager or Recruiter.

- Background Check and Offer: Recruiters move candidates into this stage once they're ready to receive their verbal offer. Before that time, this stage is where an offer is prepared and goes through approvals. This is the final stage in the process.

{{% /details %}}

{{% details summary="Scheduling tools in Greenhouse" %}}

- Candidate Experience Specialists use Modernloop to schedule.
{{% /details %}}

{{% details summary="Greenhouse for internal candidates" %}}

- There are a few elements of Greenhouse that are different for internal candidates. Please note that internal candidates refer to current, full time team members. Interns converting to full time, contractors, or rehires are not considered internal candidates.
- Interviews will always be scheduled as "private" events to ensure the candidate's privacy. Interviews will show up as "busy" events on candidate and interviewers calendars rather than showing as interviews.
- If internal applicants apply via our internal job board, the yellow "internal applicant" tag will automatically show in the GH profile. If you don't see this tag, you can add it by navigating to the "Details" tab in GH and scroll down to "Source & Responsibility". Click the pencil next to Source and select Internal Applicant from the drop down.
- CES will use the internal applicant's Google Calendar to find an appropriate time for them to meet, and do not need to be sent an availability email.
- Former GitLab team members who re-apply are not considered internal candidates. Their source should be whatever they used to apply (ie application), and you should add a "Former Team Member" tag to their profile.

{{% /details %}}

{{% details summary="Candidate Hygiene" %}}

- {{% details summary="Merging candidates" %}}
- Recruiters should merge applicant profiles whenever you see the opportunity and can verify that the candidates are the same. Merging applicant profiles allows you to keep data up to date, and also ensures that you know the full application history of anyone who applies. Aside from Internal candidates who should be merged right before hiring, you can merge candidates at any stage of the process.
- All of Talent Acquisition has access to merge profiles. You can merge candidate profiles by viewing the right hand toolbar on an applicant profile, and clicking on either the alert that appears at the top of the toolbar or 'See More' in the 'Tools' section. Before beginning, please ensure that the profiles are a match for each other by verifying that their emails, phone numbers, and/or resumes are the same.
- When selecting which profile is Primary (right side), consider the following:
- As a default, the most recent applicant profile should most likely be the Primary one, unless the most recent is a Prospect.
- If this is an internal candidate, the most recent profile should always be Primary, but should not be merged until the candidate has accepted their offer to minimize the number of people with access to this information.
- After merging, check the Activity Feed and Details tabs to see what information was removed from old profiles and ensure that you have the most accurate Recruiter, Coordinator, and Source.
- If you have any questions, please contact the Enablement Manager because profile merges cannot be undone.

{{% /details %}}

- {{% details summary="Adding or transferring candidates between jobs" %}}

- If a candidate is in one job and needs to move to another, it's important to correctly

determine whether they should be added or transferred. Both are accessible by clicking the 'Add, Transfer, or Remove Candidate's Jobs' button on the bottom right corner of your candidate profile.

- Before making any moves, always ensure the candidate does not have any interviews scheduled. Transferring will automatically remove scheduled interviews and make them invisible on the candidates' Guide, but will not cancel the interview from the interviewers' calendar or inform the candidate of what is happening. Always wait until the interview has been completed, or fully cancel the interview and reschedule under the new req.

- When you add a candidate to a new job, the candidate starts the new job with a clean slate. There will be no scorecards or forms from any other position. This should be chosen when you are starting a brand new hiring process and will not be considering scorecards from any other job, and want their application date to be the date that you add them.

- When you transfer a candidate from one job to another, most of their data before the reference check stage moves with them. Scorecards will be visible in the "Scorecards" tab and their original application date will remain. Scorecards that have not been submitted cannot be submitted after transfer, so make sure you collect those before you make your move. Offers and forms are also not transferable, so it's important to transfer before a candidate hits the Reference Check stage. When you are moving someone from an Evergreen req into the role they will be hired into, you should always transfer. There will be no record of the previous job in any reporting.

- Sometimes, deciding whether to add or transfer can be tricky. If a candidate interviewed for a role that was filled by someone else, and you get a new headcount a few months later, should you transfer them into the new job or add them and start over? One thing to consider is the implication your choice will have on the data. In this case, a candidate who transfers will appear to have been in the hiring process for months, when you've actually only been talking to them about this opening for a few days. At the same time, you want to save their scorecards because they'll be relevant for the new job. In another situation, you could have an applicant who was being considered for the role, was rejected by the Hiring Manager, but contacted a few months later when the scope of the role changed and they were now considered a good fit. The key to knowing when to transfer is understanding what impact it would have on our data, and what solution would paint the most accurate picture. If you're not sure whether to add or transfer, you should check in with Enablement to get another opinion.

{{% /details %}}

- {{% details summary="Rejecting candidates" %}}

- When rejecting candidates, it's important to carefully review all rejection reasons and pick the one that most accurately describes why a candidate is being rejected. This is because data is analyzed on a quarterly basis by the Talent Acquisition Leadership team, People Leadership Team, and E-Group.

- Once you've clicked the most detailed reason, include detailed context on the reason in the "Rejection Notes" box. Please be as specific as possible. For example, instead of writing "the candidate rejected because of compensation", write "the candidate rejected because the salary and equity that we offered was much lower than a competing offer."

- Please note that you cannot submit scorecards after rejecting a candidate.

- We will not cancel an interview within less than 24 hours' notice if the candidate is being rejected. The recruiter will notify the candidate that they are no longer in consideration for the role and present them with the option to continue with the scheduled interview slot. The interviewer must be informed, and will not discuss the feedback that led to the decline. The conversation will pivot to general opportunities at GitLab and answering any questions about the company and team that the candidate may have.

- If the candidate's interview is outside 24 hours, the interview should be deleted in Greenhouse before the candidate is rejected and notified. The candidate should always be notified if they've been rejected, and the recruiter is responsible for declining the candidate. Any interviews scheduled will also not be automatically canceled, so you'll need to ensure this happens first.
- If the candidate does not join the interview room within 10 minutes or fails to complete their MR within the specified time before the interview, the interview will be cancelled and the recruiter will get in touch with the candidate and not schedule further interviews.
- If the candidate notifies us that they are unable to attend the interview before the scheduled time, CES can automatically reschedule using the candidates' current availability or by requesting fresh availability.
- If we have rescheduled at the request of the candidate and the candidate requests to move the interview again without reasonable explanation, the recruiter will automatically reject the candidate.
- We understand that there may be extenuating circumstances leading to the above situations where a candidate is unavailable or unprepared. It is at the recruiter's discretion to reengage or choose to reschedule.

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Offers and Closing Reqs

{{% details summary="Reference Checks" %}}

- Reference check information
- Reference check forms are mandatory. If you receive reference check information outside of the form and don't want a candidate to fill it out again, Enablement can help you adjust the form to collect the remaining information. These forms are important because they provide necessary information for the accuracy and completion of a contract.
- {{% details summary="Tips and Tricks" %}}
- These forms, just like an offer in Greenhouse, do not transfer when you move a candidate from one job to another. Ensure that your candidate is in the role they'll be hired for before sending.
- Completed forms live in a candidate's "application" tab. If you can't find the form, it's likely there!
- While nicknames, preferred last names, and PIAA details will save to the details page automatically, legal name will not. Please ensure the legal first and last name is set as the candidates' name before sending contracts.
- If you have a candidate in the Netherlands, they are required to provide their BSN and date of birth. Recruiters should add those fields into the offer.

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{{% details summary="Offers" %}}

- Creating an offer in Greenhouse
- {{% details summary="Common approval challenges" %}}
- Offer stuck in approvals: If the offer is stuck in the approvals chain because someone is out of office, the recruiter can talk to the approver's manager about an appropriate temporary adjustment and recommend this to the Enablement team. Recruiters should be proactive in

reaching out to approvers if an offer is urgent or a candidate is being inconvenienced by a long wait time. If there is a known OOO, this discussion should happen before there's an offer waiting for approval. Enablement can help with any changes needed.

- Offer approvals chain is incorrect: If approvers are missing or incorrect, the Recruiter should contact a member of the Enablement team to adjust. The only people with access to make approvers changes are Enablement and Director, Executive Recruiting, who change approval chains to maintain confidentiality for executive positions. Often, approval chains are incorrect because you have chosen the wrong department, so it's important to choose the right one before opening your req.

{{% /details %}}

- Verbal offer information

- Declined offer steps

{{% details summary="Background screens" %}}

- Contact the Senior Background Check Specialist at backgroundchecks@gitlab.com with any questions or requests for status updates.

- The most commonly asked question for candidates outside the US is, "Why can't I enter more than one past employer?" Outside of the US, candidates will only submit one former employer and Sterling is working as expected.

{{% /details %}}

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Sourcing at GitLab

- Sourcing overview

- Identifying prospects

Notifications

There are no perfect or required ways to set up your Greenhouse notifications, but these are some of our recommendations.

{{% details summary="Slack" %}}

- To set up Slack to notify you when you're tagged in candidate notes, select your initials in the upper right hand corner of Greenhouse. From there, you can activate your Slack integration. Toggle the button to send @mentions to Slack. This is also a great button to point out to Hiring Managers so they are easier for the team to reach.

- Additionally, you will see a section for "Notification Preferences". Most recruiters will set these up, but they are optional if you prefer to only receive notifications by email.

{{% /details %}}

{{% details summary="Email notifications" %}}

- There are two ways to set up your email notifications. The first is to select your initials in the top right corner of Greenhouse, and under "notification preferences", select where you would like to receive notifications about jobs. This is an easy way for Hiring Managers to set up their preferences for all jobs at once, but may not be as easy for the Talent Acquisition team to remember to update.

- Instead, we would recommend setting your reminders either during your job setup process or after, by clicking into your Notifications tab of an individual job's Job Setup. Here, we recommend that you stay in the loop on your candidates by electing to receive emails every time a scorecard is submitted, an internal candidate applies, a referral is submitted, and an offer is fully approved. You can choose your name or "Candidate's Recruiter", but you'll want to be sure that you're listed as the recruiter on the role to make this work. Recruiters should double check during this time that no one is receiving notifications that should not (ie an interviewer receiving offer notifications) and adjust privacy settings accordingly.
 - You can sync your emails between Greenhouse and Gmail. Greenhouse has a Gmail add-on that can help with syncing communications. You can learn more about it by going [here](#).
- {{% /details %}}

Talent Acquisition Programs

Referrals

- Referral Operations
- Referral Process
- Details on who is eligible for referrals

Acquisitions

- Acquisitions

Internal Mobility

- Internal Hiring Process
- Posting a job internally
- In the offer process

Emerging Talent

Emerging Talent

- Associate Engineer Development

Global Hiring Resources

{{% details summary="Global hiring links" %}}

- The "country hiring status" section within the compensation calculator is the best place to look for a list of current countries available for hiring.
 - This country list, maintained by and accessible to recruiters, details specific information about each country that can help you answer candidate questions and prepare for potential hiring delays.
 - For general questions about specific policies or whether we support certain types of visas or sponsorship, message people-group-confidential. If the request is more involved, or requires a conversation, you can slack Harley Devlin.
- {{% /details %}}

{{% details summary="PEO information and timelines" %}}

- For candidates who are located in Countries where we do not have an entity, we use a PEO (Professional Employment Organization). The actual employment contracts will be sent and issued by the PEO who also handles the processing and payment of payroll and associated taxes and compliance in each of the countries on behalf of GitLab. The contracts themselves are between the individual and the PEO.
- GitLab is currently hiring into three PEOs
- Remote.com
- Global Upside
- Papaya
- Global Expansion
- The following timelines to onboarding are advised:

Remote.com: remote.com onboarding timeline

Country Working days
----- -----
Denmark 3
Hungary 4
Italy 3
Sweden 3
Luxembourg 4
Switzerland 8

Global Expansion:

Processing contracts for candidates hired via Global Expansion could take up to 10 business days.

Country Working days
----- -----
Austria 10 business days
Chile 10 business days
Costa Rica 10 business days
Kenya 10 business days
Latvia 10 business days
Mexico 10 business days
Philippines 10 business days
South Africa 10 business days
UAE 10 business days

Global Upside:

Country Working days
----- -----
India 10-14 business days

Papaya

Processing for Italy (Dirigenti) could take up to a month, so we recommend start dates at least 6 weeks after the offer is generated.

{{% /details %}}

Other Hiring Pages

- Greenhouse
- Talent Acquisition Process Framework

Additional Resources

- Overview of Job Families
- Background checks
- Benefits
- Compensation
- Contracts
- GitLab talent ambassador
- Onboarding
- Stock options
- Visas

SECTION: hiring/associate-engineer-development.md

Congratulations and welcome to the GitLab team! We're excited to have you on board as you start this exciting new chapter in your engineering career. Our comprehensive ongoing development program is designed to support you every step of the way - from your first day, to your first merge request, and beyond. You'll have support from your manager, onboarding buddy, and the Talent Development team; don't ever hesitate to reach out.

Get ready to explore new technologies and skills, collaborate with GitLab team members around the globe, and grow in an environment where your success and results are our priority. Let's dive in and make great things happen together!

Building your GitLab Community

Working from your GitLab home office, with team members spread across the globe, might feel a bit daunting or lonely. It's important to invest time and energy into building your community here so that you have support and guidance. All Associate Engineers will be included in a private Slack channel, made specifically for Associates. This space can serve as a support network for you to learn from each other's experiences and problem solve when challenging projects come up. We encourage you to lean on and learn from each other!

Don't forget about the wider GitLab team member community, too. There are lots of places to meet and connect with team members across the organization. Here are some examples:

| Slack Channel | Description |

| ----- | ----- |

| Social Slack Channels | A HUGE list of social channels to join based on your interests - try

cooking, gaming, dog, cats, travel, or music. Can't find a channel for your favorite hobby? Start one and post about it in [whats-happening-at-gitlab](#) so others know to join! | [Team Member Resource Groups](#) | These groups help team members build stronger internal and external connections; offer social, educational, and outreach activities; create development opportunities for future leaders; and increase engagement among team members. Find a list of TMRGs [here](#). |

Prioritizing your Development

Skill development and career growth are important for all team members at GitLab. We've designed a custom and ongoing development plan for our associate engineers that is built to provide structure and resources for you to thrive at GitLab. Below, you'll find more about what you can expect.

Your First Week at GitLab

Our GitLab team starts using the product on Day 1 for onboarding with our onboarding issue. You'll start here, too.

The first week at GitLab can feel like a lot - getting used to your new at home workspace, meeting your manager and colleagues, and working through values and compliance trainings. It's a great week to have a few coffee chats with your onboarding buddy, get to know your manager, and introduce yourself in the new-team-members Slack channel.

In your first week, expect to get connected with other associate engineers at GitLab. You'll also be paired with your onboarding buddy, a go-to resource for you for all questions you have throughout your first few weeks at GitLab.

Week 2: Getting Familiar with the GitLab Engineering Team

Don't worry if you've not finished your Week 1 onboarding issue yet - keep working through the assignments there! In Week 2, you'll also get assigned your department-specific, engineering onboarding issue, which will guide you through the basics of your department and role. Here's what you can expect:

- Dive deeper into the GitLab product architecture and engineering workflows to understand the technical landscape
- Meet with key members of the engineering departments and learn about their teams, projects, and responsibilities
- Begin working on initial assignments to apply your skills and contribute to the codebase
- Shadow other teams or participate in pair programming sessions with experienced engineers
- Attend customer or client meetings to gain a better understanding of user needs and business objectives

Training and Workshops

The Talent Development team curates a robust schedule of training sessions, workshops, and lunch-and-learns to help you expand your technical skills and knowledge. These cover a wide range of topics, from new programming languages to agile methodologies.

In your first month at GitLab, you'll be assigned a custom learning path from O'Reilly learning. O'Reilly's self paced courses are some of the best in the industry for learning skills like

- Ruby on Rails
- Vue.js
- Docker
- Kubernetes

Along with this self paced work, you'll start exploring opportunities to advance your technical skills in the flow of work at GitLab in spaces like:

- Internal hackathons and innovation days
- Reviewing Community Contributions (and owning stagnant contributions)
- Specialized tech tracks for areas like Machine Learning, Security, or Performance Optimization
- Contribution to open-source projects, fostering practical skills and community involvement
- Peer-led sessions and reverse mentoring to foster a learning culture.
- Technology rotation program to broaden exposure to different aspects of the product.
- And more!

Expect to hear from the Talent Development team during your first week at GitLab, and then again after about 2 or 3 weeks to see how you're doing. From there, you'll hear from Talent Development every quarter with news on workshops, trainings, and other resources to support your skill development.

Career Pathing

Together with your manager, you'll create a personalized Individual Growth Plan (IGP) to identify your strengths, areas for growth, and the steps needed to reach your professional aspirations. We'll work with you to unlock new opportunities and help you progress in your career.

Feedback and Performance Reviews

You'll receive regular feedback and coaching from your manager to help you understand your progress and areas for improvement. Formal performance reviews will provide a structured opportunity to discuss your achievements, growth, and future goals.

The GitLab team is committed to supporting your development and helping you reach your full potential. Embrace the opportunities ahead, and don't hesitate to reach out for guidance and support along the way.

Technical Assessments

You'll participate in technical assessments to review your learning and performance with your manager and mentors. These assessments could include:

1. Coding challenges
1. Project review

1. Peer feedback
1. Simulation exercises

Questions and Support

Don't hesitate to reach out. If you need support with your development, or have ideas about how to grow faster and stronger in your engineering role, speak directly to your manager or reach out in the [learninganddevelopment](#) Slack channel.

SECTION: hiring/conducting-a-gitlab-interview.md

Overview

Interviewing can be challenging for both parties involved. In a relatively short space of time, a decision must be made about the potential collaboration. This page aims to provide clear guidelines to ease the interview process for everyone.

Interviewer Training Requirements

New internal interviewers must complete the interviewer training module in Level Up, or as a part of the Becoming a GitLab Manager issue template.

It is typically expected for new hires to focus on and complete their onboarding for at least two weeks before being part of an interview team. There may be extenuating circumstances where a team member needs to participate in interviewing sooner than this, but they should always complete the interviewing training module in LevelUp and discuss the role thoroughly with their manager and the recruiter prior to being on an interview team.

Interviewing Philosophy

Being an interviewer is an area where you have an outsized impact on our ability to grow and accomplish the business goals we have as an organization. Your role is to use skill-based questions to gauge a candidate's fit for GitLab. You also have the opportunity to paint a picture of our work environment, values and team spirit. Remember, interviews can be nerve-wracking, so create a comfortable space for candidates to shine. It's your input that enables hiring teams to make informed hiring decisions and ensure we are continuing to inclusively grow our teams with the right teammates, in the right roles, at the right time.

Confidentiality

Please note the importance of confidentiality in the interview process for both internal and external interview processes. Candidates should not be discussed outside of the hiring manager management chain. It is important to respect the privacy of all candidates who apply for positions at GitLab, whether they are internal or external.

All feedback should be recorded in Greenhouse and/or discussed live with the hiring manager and/or interview team as applicable.

Before the Interview

Familiarize yourself with the job description

- Ensure you've read the description of the role you're going to be interviewing candidates for. This can be found in the job family page.
- If you have any questions about the scope of the role, the team, or the responsibilities of the position after you've read through those resources be sure to reach out to the Hiring Manager with your questions.

Align with the Hiring Manager on competencies

- It's important to have a clear understanding of what you are assessing during your time with the candidate. Your recruiter will partner with the Hiring Manager and the rest of the interview team to ensure alignment.

Review the interview kit in Greenhouse

- In the interview kit, you'll be able to view the candidate's resume, the description of the interview you're expected to lead, the scorecard you'll be evaluating the candidate against, and the suggested questions you ask during the interview.

Make sure you're up to date on our latest Talent Brand assets and accomplishments

- Make sure you know our latest headcount, notable awards, messaging, and other facts about working at GitLab. Take a look at these talent brand resources to help guide your conversation with candidates.

Learn more about pre-interviewing preparation in the Interviewer Training Module in Level Up.

During the Interview

Interview Structure

It's important to allocate the right amount of time for each part of the interview. You can think of the structure of an interview as having 3 parts: 1) introductions, 2) questions for the candidate, and 3) questions from the candidate.

Time allocated to each part of the interview:

1. Introductions = 5%
1. Interviewer questions for the candidate = 80-85%
1. Candidate questions for the interviewer = 5-10%

Quick Tips

- Show up prepared and on time.
- Be cognizant of where the candidate is at in the interview process. Are you the first interviewer? Are you the third? Be aware that the candidate has likely repeated themselves quite a bit and has already asked many of the general questions they had about the position in

previous interviews.

- Build rapport and put the candidate at ease. Introduce yourself, tell your GitLab story, ask how the candidate is doing.
- Talk about your relation to the job and how you'd work together based on your position.
- Set expectations on how the interview will run.
- As candidates move through the interviewing process, interviewers take notes within Greenhouse. As they move through the process, interviewers have the opportunity to review any specific notes previous interviewers have left for them, although the full feedback notes from previous interviewers are obscured from current ones in an effort to avoid creating bias. Hiring managers, executives, and people ops are able to see all feedback notes at any time.
- Let the candidate know you are taking notes
- Be an active listener
 - Concentrate on the candidate - remove all distractions (turn off notifications on your phone, slack, email, etc.) Look at the candidate - make sure to look at your camera and not at another screen
- Try not to interrupt - validate your assumptions by explaining what you understood, and allow the candidate to correct your understanding of the story Silence is golden
- Cover the prepared topics/questions without being mechanical
 - Work with the hiring team to set up the interview plan in Greenhouse ahead of the interview to ensure all the areas you want to cover are in the scorecard.
- Try to cover the prepared topics, but keep the conversation smooth - it is ok to skip around.
- Redirect the conversation as needed - you are in charge of keeping the conversation focused and timely. It is common for candidates to be nervous and overextend on a question, and interrupting might be necessary. To handle this scenario, you might:
 - instruct the candidate at the beginning of the interview that you might need to interrupt them to move to a different topic ("I want to make sure we have the opportunity to cover everything, so it is my job to guide the pace of the discussion. Sometimes, we'll go into more depth, other times, I will ask that we move on to the next topic. Please understand that I'm not doing so because I'm not interested in what we're talking about at the time, it's merely to keep us on track.")
 - interrupt them and explain why they are being interrupted ("Thanks for that - I'll have to cut you off there, thanks, I understand what you're saying. I want to make sure you have a fair go for the rest of the interview so we have to be efficient with the time we have.")
- Consider adding the question to the meeting chat after verbalising. This helps avoid communication issues and be more inclusive.
- There is an unbalanced power relationship during the interview, and interviewers should be mindful of this fact. The interviewer is in a powerful position: they provide input that could decide if the candidate will move forward or not. Be as friendly and approachable as you can. This has the added value of getting people comfortable (over time) and allows you to get much better data.
- Interview for soft skills. Pick some behavioral questions to get data on what the candidate has done before and how their behavior aligns with the company values. You will be asked to evaluate how the candidate's values align with our own in your feedback form, and asking behavioral questions is the best way to assess this.
- If a candidate discloses outside project(s) or activity(ies), please notify the Recruiter.
- Always encourage the interviewee to ask questions at the end, and be frank in your answers.
- Be willing to discuss what went well and any concerns you may have.
- Manage expectations - Don't make promises on what they can expect, but tell them that their Recruiter will be in touch with the next steps

- Thank the candidate for their time.

Inclusive Interviewing

As an interviewer, it's crucial that you create an inclusive interview environment. This not only ensures a fair and equitable assessment of candidates, it also enhances your ability to recognize diverse strengths and contributions from each individual.

The section below outlines questions and topics that are not allowed to be discussed during an interview and offers guidance on steering conversations back to job-related topics.

Illegal Interview Questions

1. Be aware of the kinds of questions you can and can't ask by attending or revisiting LevelUp training. It's important to adhere to legal guidelines and avoid discriminatory inquiries.
1. It's important to focus on the candidate's ability to perform the job responsibilities rather than personal characteristics or background.
1. Refrain from any personal, icebreaker-type questions that may inadvertently lead to discrimination or reveal protected information about a candidate. For instance, asking a candidate about a particular holiday could elicit information about the candidate that an employer finds undesirable yet is still legally protected.
1. Refrain from asking any questions related to protected classes such as age, race, gender, gender identity, religion, sexual orientation, marital or family status, pregnancy status, national origin, ancestry, physical or mental disabilities. These questions are not only illegal, but irrelevant to assessing a candidate's qualifications for a role.
1. Protected classes may differ by country, so it's important to adhere to the strictest country definitions to ensure compliance regardless of a candidate's location.
1. To find out more about discrimination laws specific to the country of a candidate you're interviewing, you can reach out to the legal-employment and/or talent acquisition team.
1. If a candidate brings up personal information related to a protected class, acknowledge their comment and steer the conversation to job-related topics. Do not include this in your interview notes, as it is not relevant to the job.
1. Examples of illegal interview questions include inquiries about marital status, age or any other protected characteristic.
1. Avoid discussing compensation, equity, country hiring guidelines, availability or confidential company information during the interview. These topics should be redirected to the Recruiter to discuss with the candidate.

Security Awareness for Interviewers

Understanding the Concern

We've identified increased risks from malicious actors attempting to gain employment under false identities. These individuals pose a significant security threat to GitLab as they may:

- Attempt to access sensitive company information
- Engage in extortion if discovered
- Use our systems to launch attacks against other organizations

What We're Doing About It

Our Talent Acquisition team is partnering with Security to address these threats through:

- Working with the Digital Experience team to implement website-level filtering
- Creating spam logic to block submissions from suspicious email addresses and IP addresses

Your Role as an Interviewer

All interviews following a recruiter screen should take place on camera for both the candidate and interviewer. If the candidate is unable to use their camera because of technical issues, please indicate this in your interview notes. Seeing candidates on camera helps identify challenging interview situations, such as AI Deepfake avatars and multiple users interviewing as one candidate. If you have concerns about filters and odd behavior during an interview, please take a screenshot to send to the recruiter for reference who will then compare to other sources, such as LinkedIn or their recruiter screen. Trust your instincts- if something feels off or out of place, let your Talent Acquisition partner know.

What to Watch For

- Candidates who refuse to turn on their camera without reasonable explanation
- Visual glitches that might suggest deepfake technology
- Multiple voices or people appearing to coach the candidate
- Inconsistent responses compared to written materials
- Reluctance to discuss background details that were in their application

How to Respond

1. Complete the interview professionally
2. Document your concerns in detail in your interview notes
3. Notify your Talent Acquisition partner immediately
4. Share any screenshots or specific examples of concerning behavior

If you have questions about this process, please contact your Recruiter who will connect you with the TA Enablement team.

Competencies

As mentioned, 80-85% of the interview should be for you to ask relevant job-related questions. Behavioral and situational interview questions are designed to assess a candidate's past experiences and potential future actions through real-world examples and hypothetical scenarios.

Remember that good interviews are consistent for everyone to ensure an objective and unbiased assessment of candidates throughout the process.

Behavioral Interview Questions

The goal of behavioral questions is to get the candidate to share data on past experiences. Previous behavior is considered the most effective indicator of how a person is going to act in the future. It is important to remember that skills and knowledge can be learned easier than habitual behaviors can be changed, especially when candidates are unaware of the impact of the

undesired behaviors.

The questions are usually in the form of: "Can you tell me about a time when·?"

The kind of answer that we are looking for is to get a story that is structured following the Situation, Task, Action, and Result (STAR). Ask for an overview, an executive summary, of the case at hand. In order to avoid lengthy answers from the candidate at this stage consider briefly explaining the STAR structure before asking your first behavioral question. Stating something like - "These questions are behavioral, so try and structure your response by briefly outlining the situation, describing the task to be performed, outlining the actions you took and explaining the results."

Some things to pay attention to:

- What the candidate chose to highlight in their response is important. Are you able to get enough specific information out of their explanation and your follow up questions to sufficiently evaluate their behavior?
- Is it clearly explained? Are you able to follow the information? If it is a technical story and you are a non-technical interviewer, are things being explained in a way that is easy to understand?
- Is there a result or was the story left unfinished? Is it still going on?
- Was the result measured in any way? How does the candidate validate the result and match the expectation? Was there an expectation set to begin with?

There is no right answer; what matters here is to listen to the candidate and gather data on how they are telling the story.

These questions can be quite unbalancing and can increase the stress during the interview. Again, be kind and help the candidate understand what you are looking for, and provide an example if one is needed when you notice the candidate is blocked.

It can also happen that the candidate does not have a story to share with you; that is okay. It's just another data point that should be added to the feedback (I failed to get data on ·). Just move to the next question and be sure to have a few questions as a backup.

Situational Interview Questions

A situational interview question presents a hypothetical but potential real-world scenario to a candidate, so that you can understand how they would handle specific situations. The reason we ask situational interview questions is so we can feel confident in a candidate's skills and their potential capability to do this specific job. We are looking for people to join our team who have the skills and competencies to do the role at hand, not just someone who has done this exact thing before elsewhere.

Situational interview questions allow the opportunity to understand a candidate's approach and ability to be successful, regardless of the opportunities they have had to demonstrate that in the past.

Example: "If you were assigned a project with a tight deadline and limited resources, how would you prioritize tasks to ensure the successful completion of the project?"

Candidate Evaluation and Scorecards

Interview feedback

In Greenhouse, you will use an "interview kit" when interviewing a candidate, which has text for feedback and scorecards for skills and values. Your feedback is crucial in helping the Hiring Manager make their hiring decisions.

We want to highlight the strengths and weaknesses of the candidate in an easy to absorb, standardized way. Every scorecard must include Pros and Cons. This helps the talent acquisition team gather data that will be presented to the candidate in the form of feedback. Remember, if something is not relevant to the job, it should not be written down.

It is important that scorecards are completed within 24 hours so Talent Acquisition can keep the hiring process moving and ensure a positive candidate experience. All meeting notes should live in Greenhouse, and not in links to Google Docs or other external sources. Doing so we allow Greenhouse to be the single source of truth (SSOT) for information from the candidate for GDPR and compliance reasons.

In order to help remove bias, Interviewers (unlike Hiring Managers) are not able to see another Interviewer's scorecard. If there are certain specific flags, concerns, or notes that should be highlighted to the rest of the Interview Team, the Interviewer should add a note in their scorecard by clicking the Note for Other Interviewers section right underneath the Key Take-Aways text box.

Scoring is defined as follows (all divisions but Engineering):

- Strong Yes - Exceeded expectations of the competency (meets requirements and aligns with values)
 - You have no significant questions and are confident (to the best of your knowledge with the information at hand) that the candidate would succeed in the role.
- Yes - Met expectations of the competency (meets requirements, but may have some yellow flags)
 - You think the candidate is qualified for the role, but you are either not certain, or still have some outstanding questions that should be addressed at a later stage.
 - By default, Yes candidates should move forward in the interview process, although hiring managers should use their judgment and look for patterns in any outstanding questions or areas where it's difficult to get insight into a particular candidate. It may be appropriate to reject a candidate who does not receive stronger feedback through our process.
- No - Did not meet expectations of the competency (meets few requirements, has many yellow flags, may not align with values)
 - You think the candidate is unqualified for the role, but have some doubts or believe they performed well enough that strengths in other areas could mean that they are still able to succeed in the role.
 - Hiring managers should use their discretion to determine whether or not to continue the interview process with any candidate that receives a No vote.
- Strong No - Strongly did not meet expectations of the competency (does not meet requirements, red flags, not aligned with values)
 - You are certain this candidate is not qualified and/or not a good fit for the role.
 - There are significant flags related to Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging where this hire may create an unsafe work environment for others.

- Candidates who receive a Strong No vote should almost always be rejected immediately by the hiring manager.

Engineering Division

The scoring definitions for GitLab's Engineering Division are defined differently than the rest of the company. Rather than scores representing the probability of a hire, they are meant to reflect the candidate's interview performance. This allows us to expect scores to fit the normal distribution. The probability densities of Strong yes and Strong no should be greater than one standard deviation away from the mean.

- Strong Yes
 - Extends Yes
 - Meets an unusually large proportion of our "nice to have" criteria for the role
 - Brings interesting qualities that we were not necessarily looking for
- Yes: All must-haves criteria that were evaluated in the interview were present
- No: One, or more, must-have criteria that were evaluated were found to be missing
- Strong No
 - Extends No
 - The candidate demonstrated clear opposition to either our Collaboration, Diversity, or Results values
 - The candidate demonstrated unwillingness to learn our Efficiency, Iteration, or Transparency values

Shadowing Interviews

While it is possible to shadow interviews as a trained, regular interviewer to maintain your skillset, please be considerate of those who are actively working to become an interviewer and allow them priority in choosing when to shadow.

Just like those leading an interview, shadowers should ensure that they are not shadowing someone who they have referred to GitLab. This helps to remove bias from the interview process and does not allow specific candidates disproportionate access to interview feedback.

If you are shadowing an interview, part of this process should be taking notes and writing feedback in addition to the interviewer. Take notes using the scorecard just like you would if you were leading, but do not submit the scorecard because you are still considered to be in training during this period. As an interview training best practice, we recommend that a debrief meeting occur between the interviewer and shadow trainee after the interview to compare feedback notes (ideally in a sync meeting). Only one official scorecard should be submitted by the main interviewer. Even if you receive multiple prompts and reminders from Greenhouse as a shadow interviewer, please ignore.

More info on engineering hiring practices.

Level Categories in Engineering Scorecards

Whereas the scoring definitions company-wide describe the probability of hire, the scoring definitions in the Engineering Division are meant to reflect the candidate's interview performance. To further support the ability to utilize interview results to hire across all

levels, we have added a 'Level' category to R&D scorecards.

In this category, the interviewer can define the level the candidate scored on, and add details on why they scored a candidate on the particular level. The added value of this category is that the interviewer can score the candidate on multiple levels (ex. the Senior level and the Intermediate level).

This scorecard feature will increase sharing of candidates that, for example, may meet the 'must-have' criteria on an Intermediate level position but did not meet all of the 'must have' criteria on a Senior level. The dual score, when applicable, will help recruiters and hiring managers with candidacy decisions. Interviewers should use the notes section to capture the why behind their score and provide any additional det